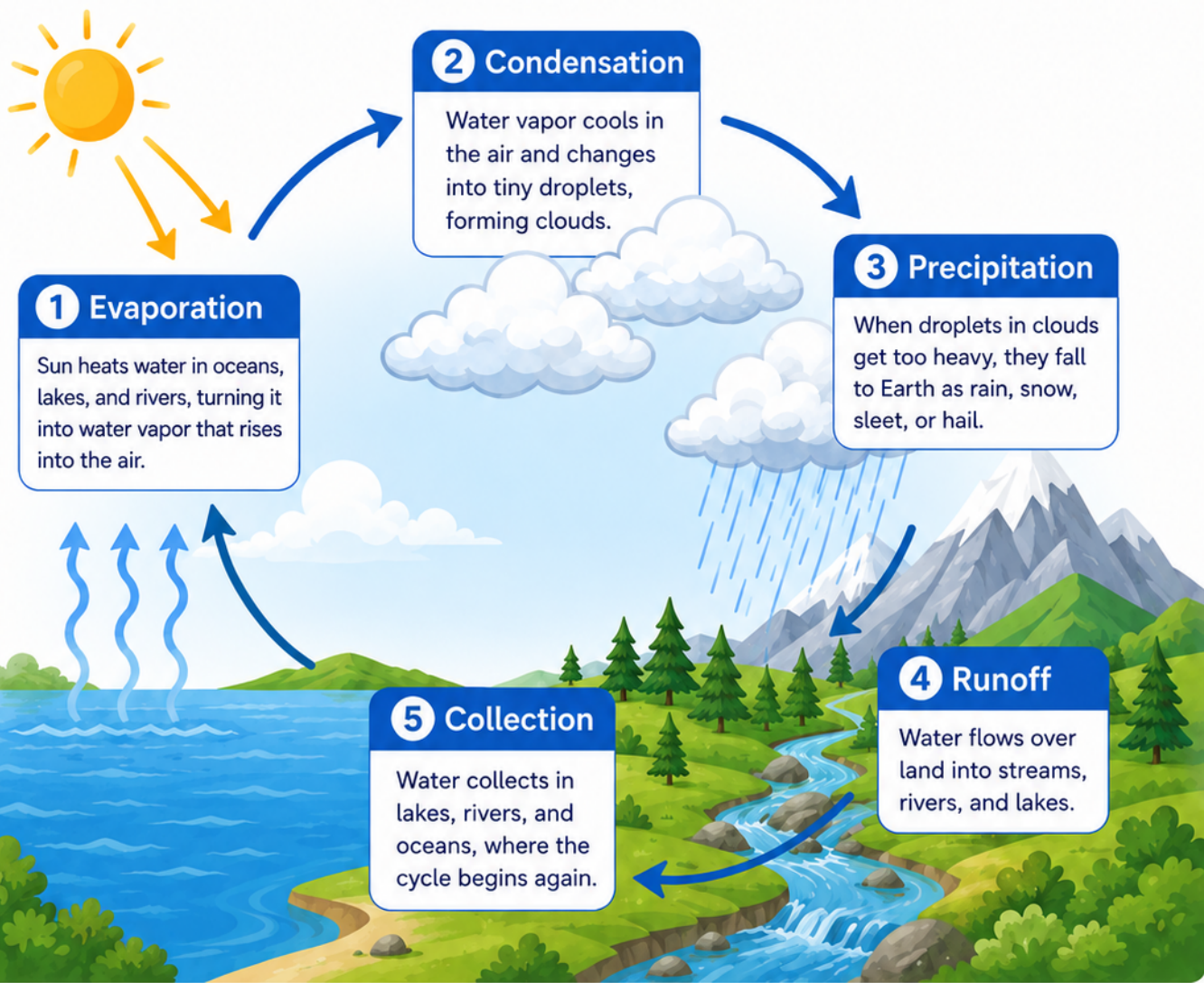


Weather Systems and the Water Cycle

Sun-Powered Earth System



Energy from the Sun powers the water cycle and drives weather.



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1 Evaporation

Sun heats water in oceans, lakes, and rivers, turning it into water vapor that rises into the air.

2 Condensation

Water vapor cools in the air and changes into tiny droplets, forming clouds.

3 Precipitation

When droplets in clouds get too heavy, they fall to Earth as rain, snow, sleet, or hail.

4 Runoff

Water flows over land into streams, rivers, and lakes.

5 Collection

Water collects in lakes, rivers, and oceans, where the cycle begins again.

